

Intern Drive Experience – Appian

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Role: Software Engineering Intern

Round 1 – Coding Round (Glider.ai)

This was an online coding round and was conducted on the Glider.ai platform, which is heavily proctored so make sure you're in a quiet environment and avoid unnecessary movements. There were 3 easy questions:

1. [Finding the First and Last Index of an Element in an Array](#)
2. [Insert Interval](#)
3. **Find the Duplicate and Missing Number in a Sequence**

Explanation: You're given numbers from 1 to n , but one number is missing and another appears twice. Find both, and check if they form a specific "pair" as per the given condition.

From what I observed, most people solved all three questions. I think the shortlisting was based on:

- Time taken to solve
- CGPA
- Number of warnings received

Out of 318 students who attended 41 were selected for the interviews.

Round 2 – Technical Interview

This round was held at CUIC. The type of questions you get depends heavily on your panel, so be ready for all aspects — DSA, DBMS, OOPS, OS, Networks, and your own projects.

Since I had mentioned participating in multiple hackathons and building several real-world projects, my interviewer focused almost entirely on project-based discussion.

I was asked to explain each project in detail:

- How the idea originated
- How we built it
- Challenges faced
- New technologies learned

He also picked specific skills from my resume and made sure to ask at least one question from each.

Never list skills you aren't confident in, and choose your words carefully ,they might dig deep into anything you mention.

Technical Questions I Was Asked based on my projects :

- Why MongoDB in one project and PostgreSQL in another.
- How I decide which database to use for different scenarios.
- Single Page Applications (SPAs) — what they are and how they work.
- LLM Fine-Tuning — methods, concepts, and practical applications.
- Git Commands — rebase, stash, merge, reset (soft/mixed/hard) and their real-world use cases.
- FastAPI vs Flask — differences, ASGI vs WSGI.
- AI Agents — architecture, decision-making process, and real-world applications.
- How Tesseract OCR works and how I implemented it in my project.
- Docker vs Virtual Machines — differences and why docker is used.
- DSA Question: [Number of Islands](#) (Asked to write algorithm and explain my approach)

He asked if I had any questions for him. Asking thoughtful questions leaves a much stronger impression than generic ones like “How's the work-life balance at Appian?” or “What's an intern's day like?”. I asked:

“Appian is a no-code platform — how does it differentiate itself from other no-code and low-code platforms using generative AI?”

This sparked a conversation about:

- His journey at Appian
- How the company started
- The innovative AI-driven project he is currently leading

Tips From This Round

- Strong, real-world projects are a huge advantage — provided you built them yourself and know them inside out.
- The challenges you faced and how you solved them often matter more
- If you don't have projects, expect theory-heavy questions from DBMS, OOPS, OS, and Networks, plus extra DSA with optimization constraints.
- Choice of words matters — answer carefully, as interviewers might dig deep into anything you say.
- Panel dynamics matter — Questions may vary drastically based on the panel you get and your responses. Try to understand what your interviewer expects and adapt your answers accordingly.

Round 3 Technical + HR

The next round was also a technical + HR round.

Again, most of the questions from previous rounds repeated — I explained my projects, how they originated, and pretty much went through the same explanations as before.

I wasn't asked any additional DSA, OOPs, or DBMS questions in this round. Instead, the interviewer seemed quite impressed by my projects and started asking very minute details about how they worked.

HR questions:

- How I got into building projects
- How I would handle a conflict in a team

I also repeated the question I asked in the previous round — he was quite impressed with that too.

There was round-wise filtering — only if you cleared a round, you moved to the next. The first round went for about 45 minutes, and the second round for about 30 minutes.

If you're immediately called for the next rounds after your previous one, chances are high that you're already on the selection track.

Final Round

This round was directly with the Regional Head of Appian. He mentioned that he personally likes to review the candidates he selects.

The interview began with some background questions:

- My CGPA, 12th and 11th marks, and even my JEE score.
- He then asked who had the highest CGPA in my class and why there was a difference between mine and theirs.
- He also asked where I would rank in my class based on CGPA.

It felt a little strange, but later he explained that he just wanted to see if academic performance matched technical skills.

Like the previous rounds, most of the time was spent on my projects.

He asked only one DBMS question, which he said has been Appian's "classic" question for years:

“What is the minimum number of tables needed for a many-to-many relationship?”

I wasn't 100% sure at the time but reasoned it out and said 2, adding that I wasn't exactly sure. (2 turned out to be correct.)

He then asked about my personal background and family.

Finally, he asked if I had any questions for him.

I said I was “repeating” the question from the previous round to get his opinion. He got slightly annoyed and said questions should be genuine, not just for formality. He was quite a serious person, so I quickly asked a fresh question and moved on.

In the end, 12 people were chosen out of the 41 for the SWE Intern role — and I was one of them.

Key Takeaways & Tips

- Be yourself and be honest — don't try to fit into a mold or pretend to be someone you're not. If you don't know something, share your thought process, admit you don't know, and show eagerness to learn.
- Find your learning style for DSA and stick to resources that work for you.
- People will often tell you to use C++ for DSA and not Python. Honestly, it doesn't matter as long as you understand the concepts and how things work under the hood.
- I went with Python because it is simpler and Python's built-in functions let me focus on solving the problem, not remembering STL syntax.

All the best

Feel free to contact for any doubts:

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